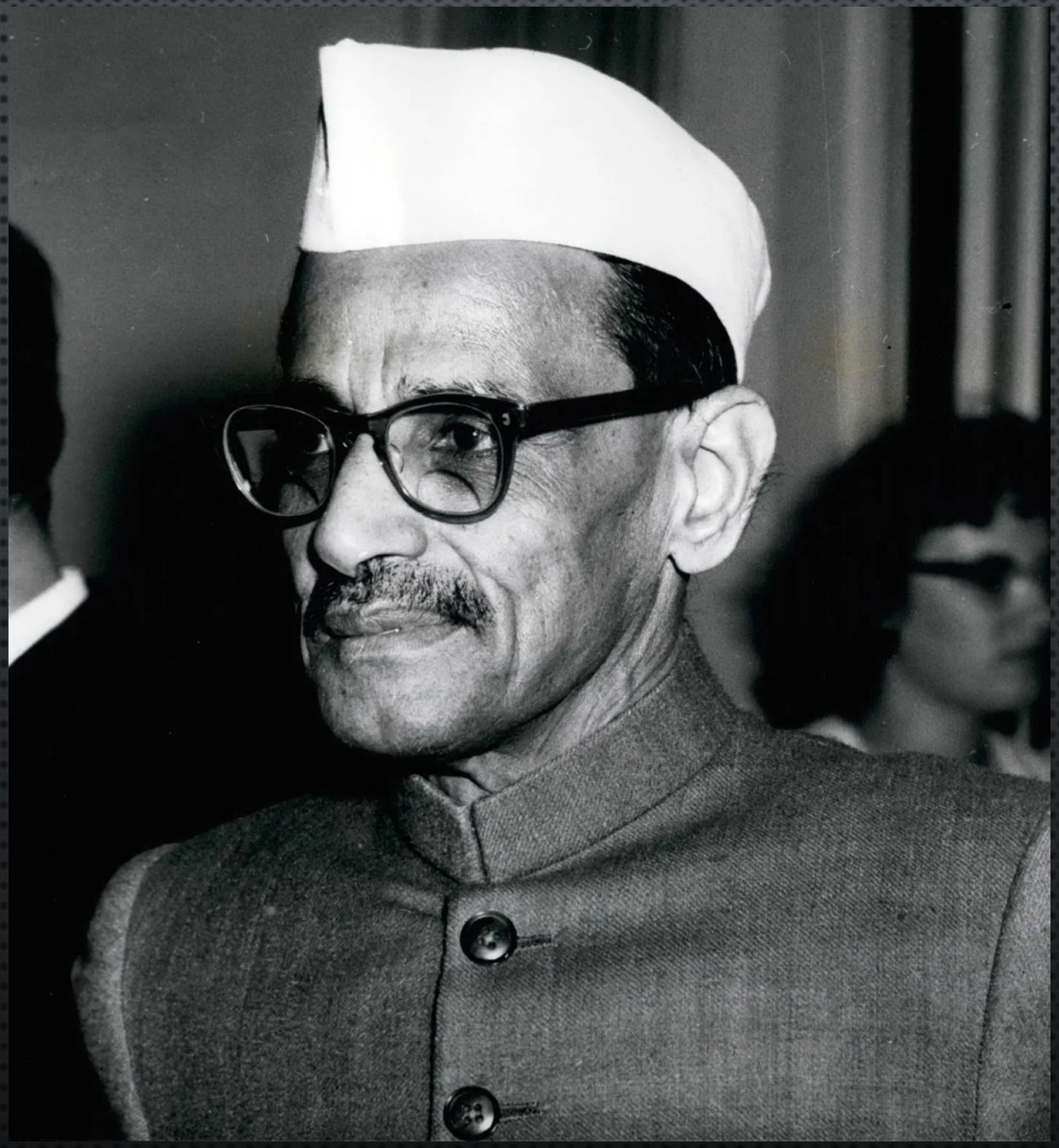
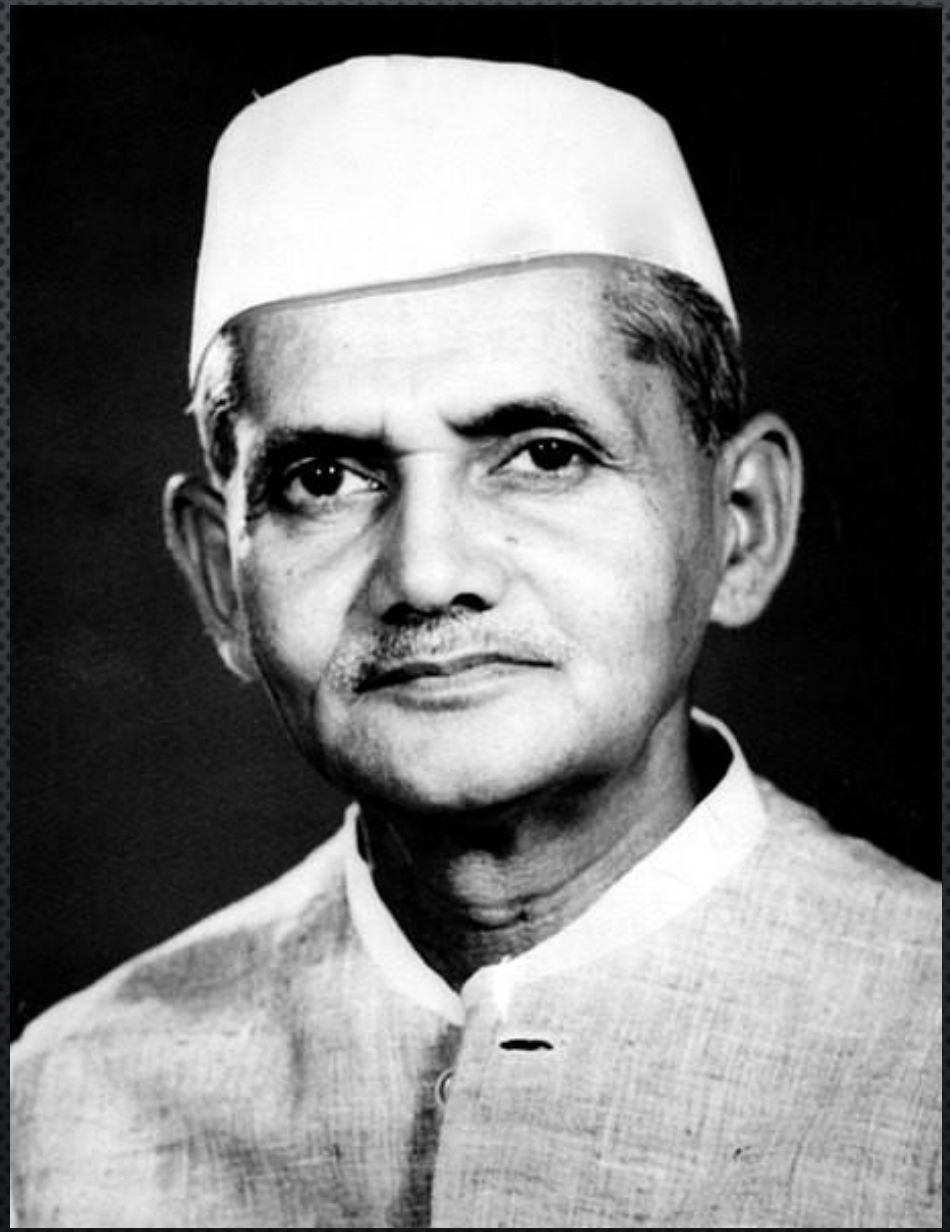
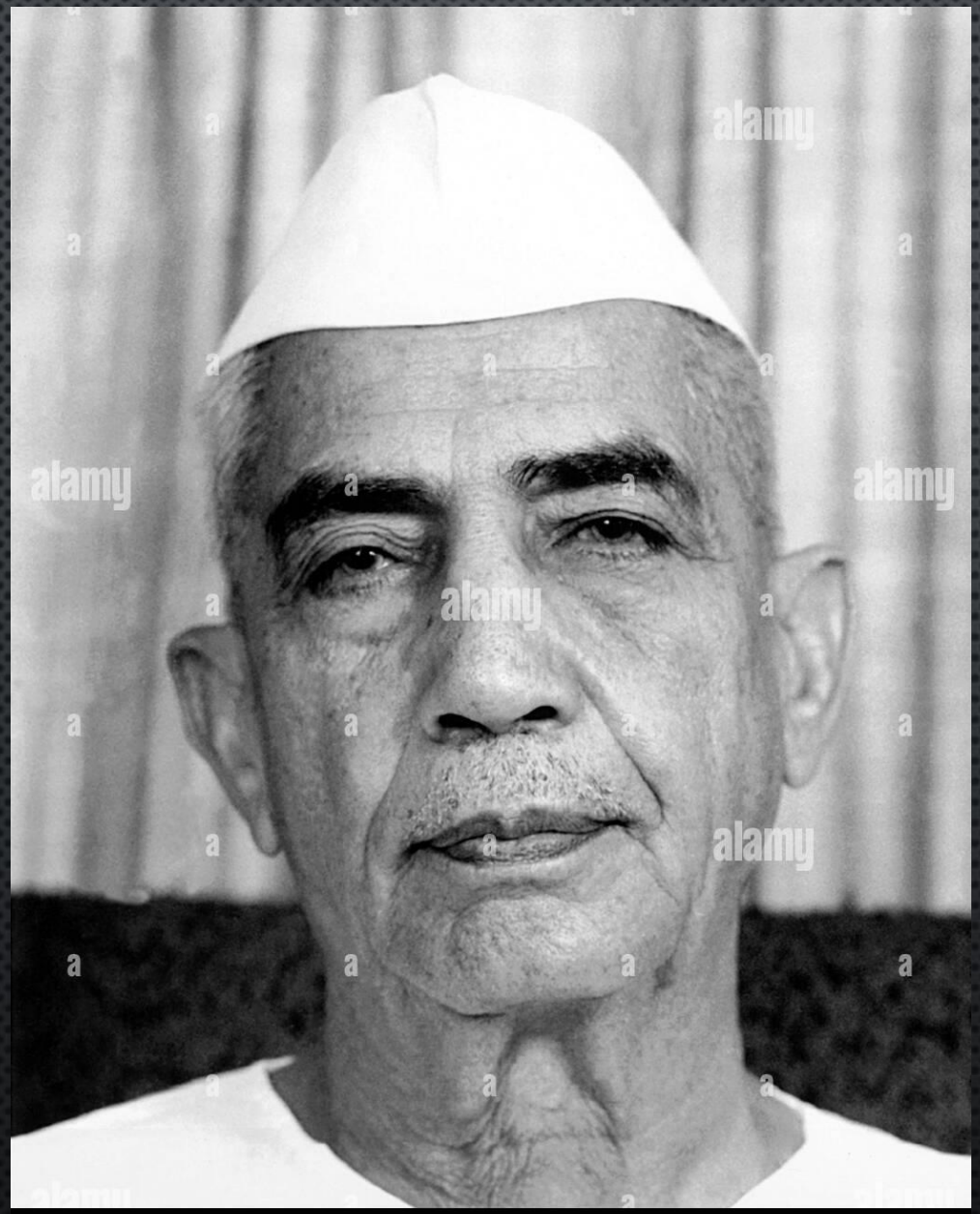
COALITION POLITICS







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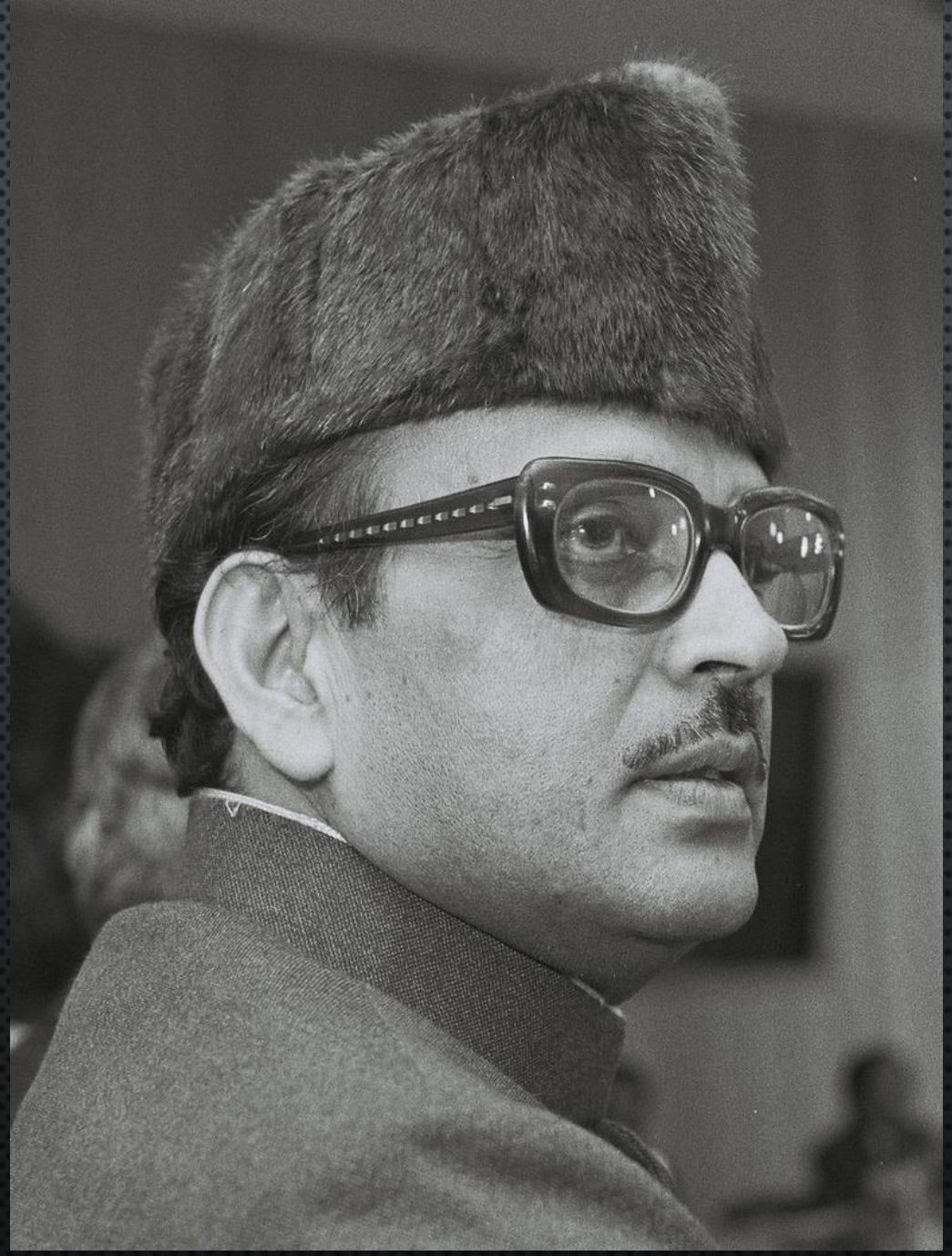
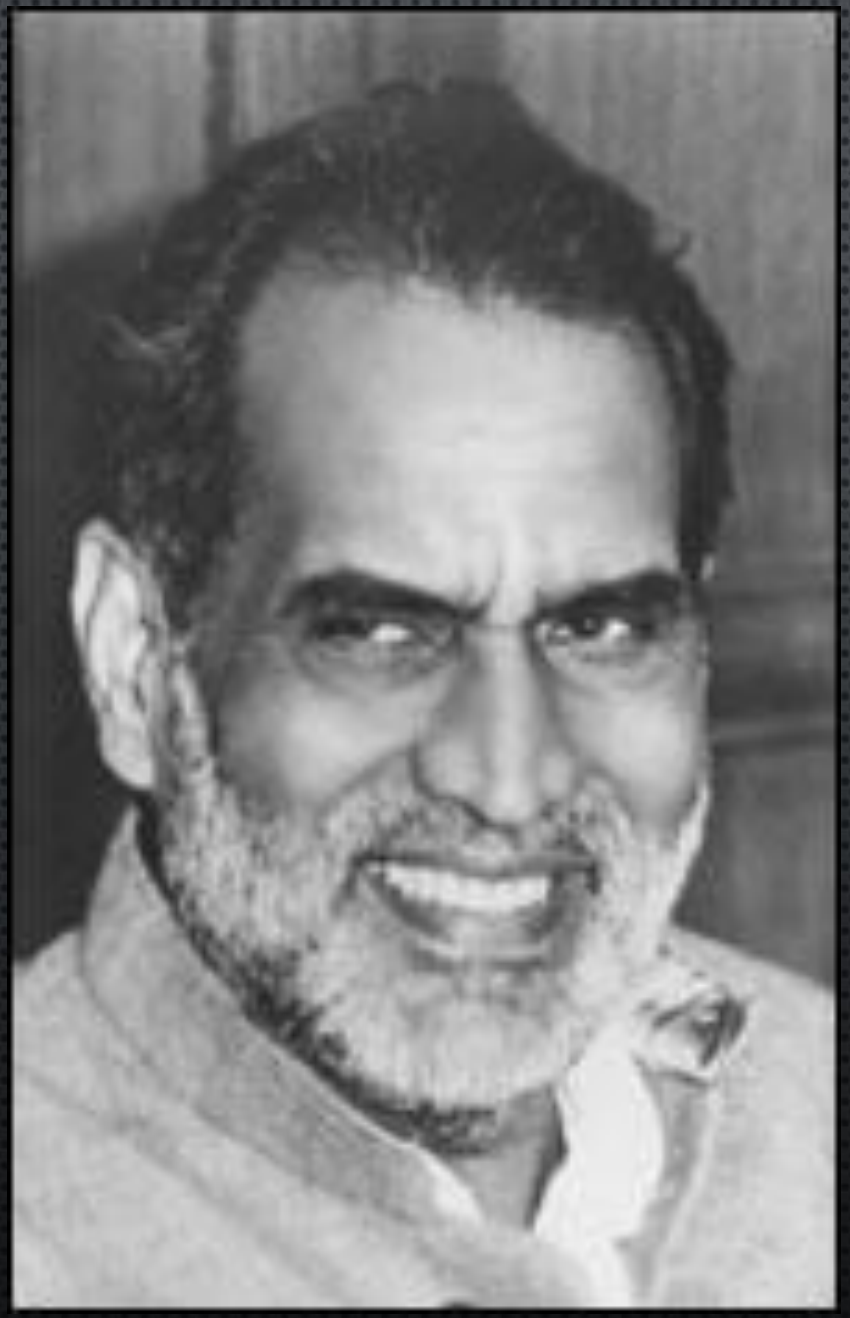
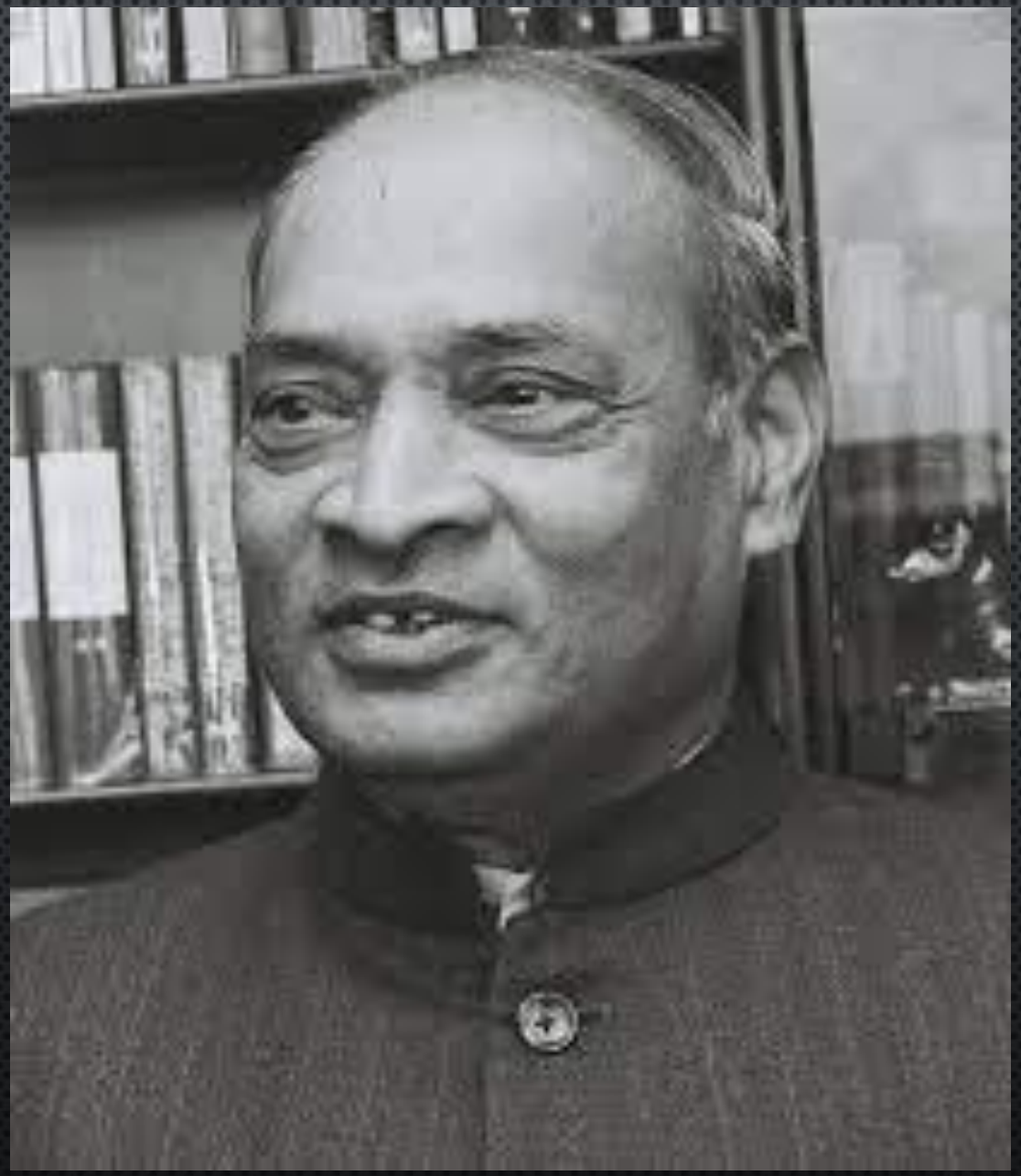
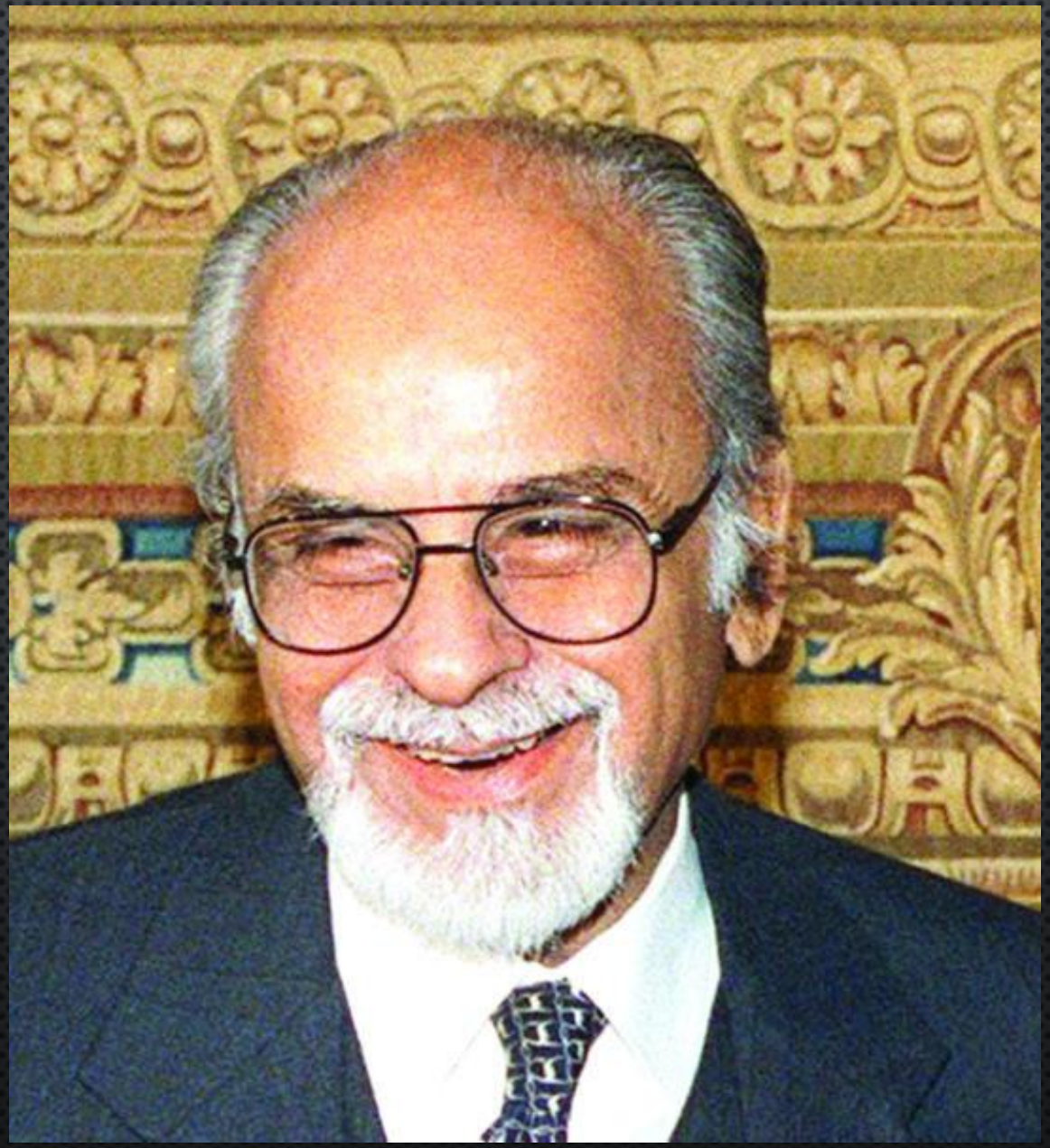
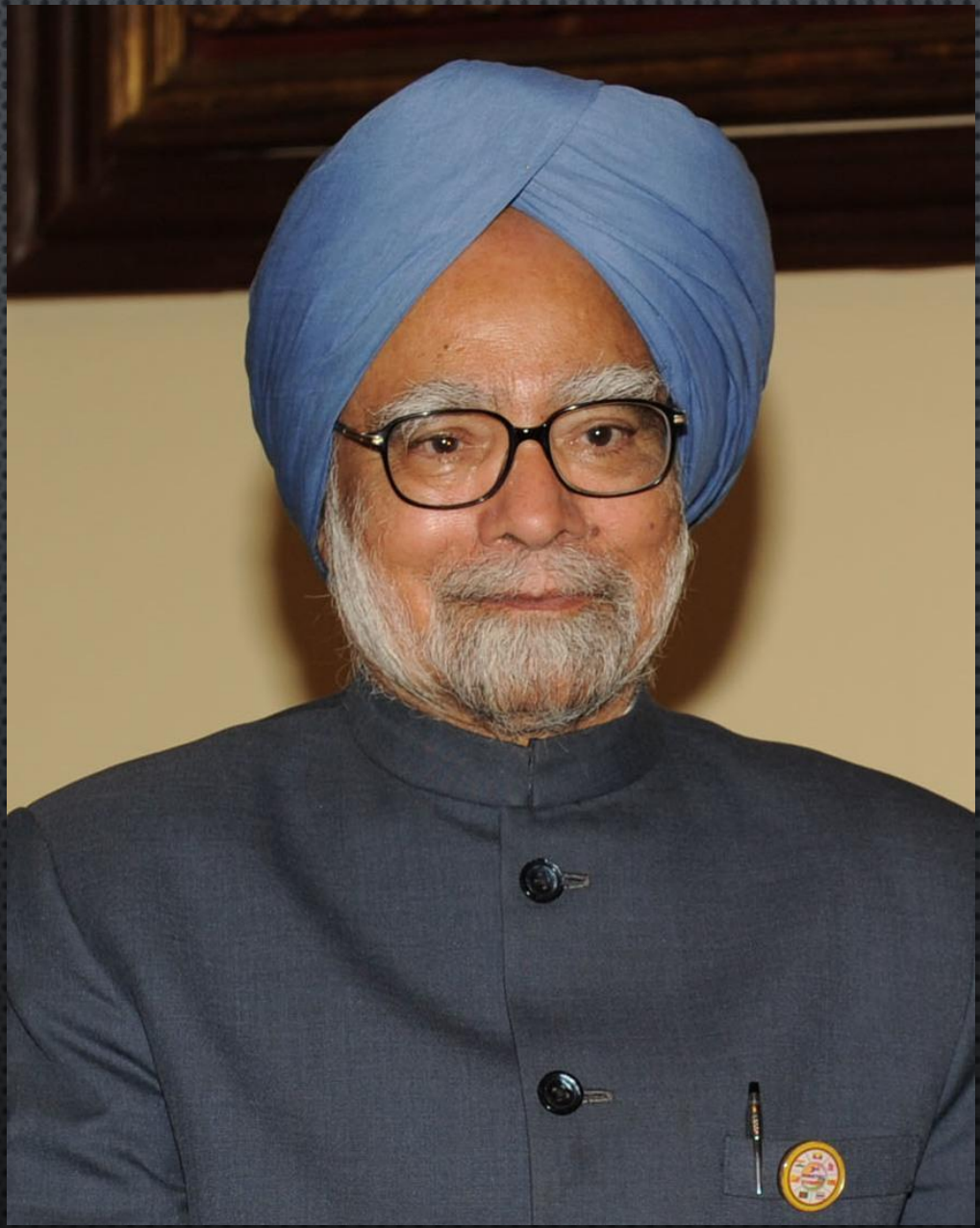










- How many lok sabha seats?
- What is parliament?

- Name of the political parties
- What is NDA or UPA/INDIA Alliance?

- In the political sense the term coalition denotes an alliance or temporary union of political forces for forming a single Government.

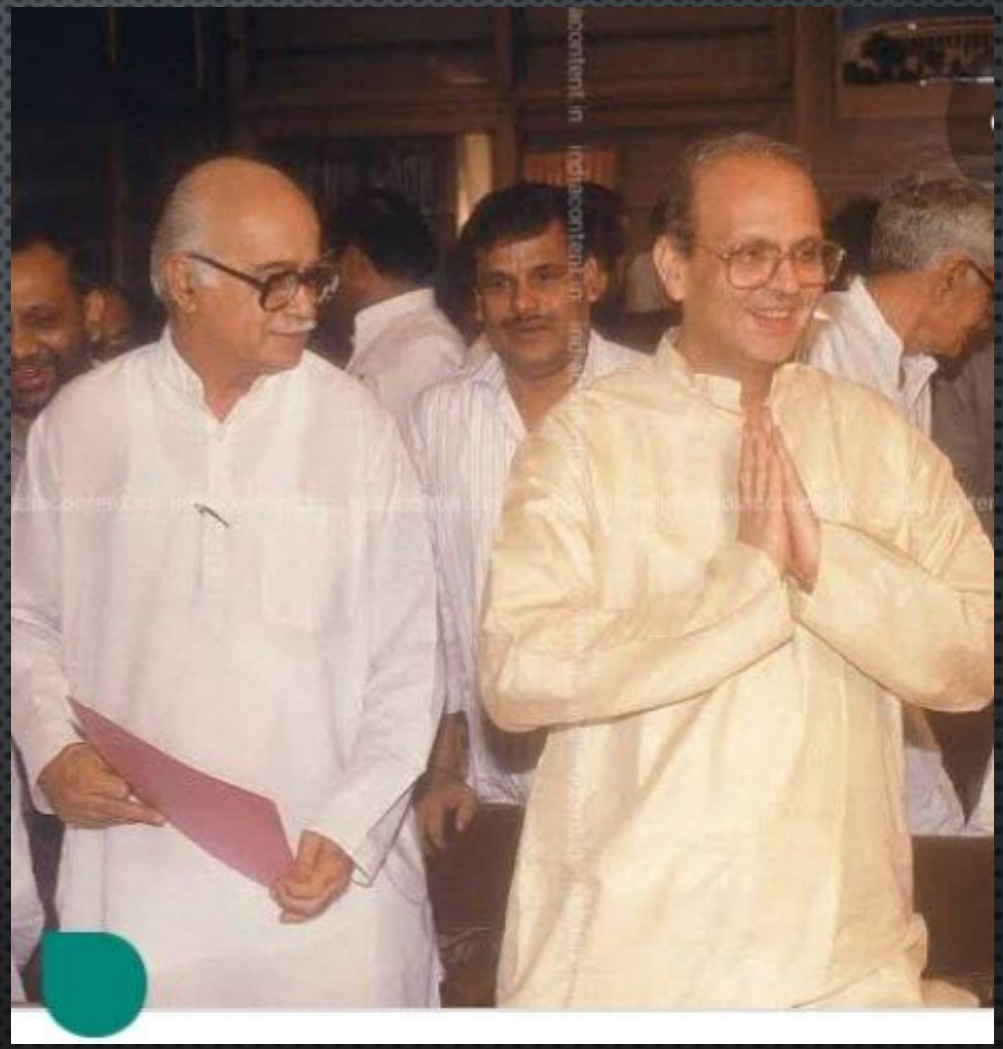
- Coalition governments are commonly contrasted with single party Governments, in which only one party forms government.

- A coalition is a grouping of rival political actors brought together either through the perception of a common threat, or the recognition that their goals cannot be achieved by working separately.

- In general terms a coalition is regarded as parliamentary or political grouping which is less permanent than a party or faction or an interest group.

- Parliamentary coalition may occur in a situation when no single party enjoys an over all majority.
- The party which is asked to form a government makes an attempt to rule as a minority government, relying upon an arrangement with other party or parties for its survival.
- the Janta Dal government led by V.P. Singh in 1989 was such a government.
- Such a government may seek support from the opposition political parties for different items of legislation or the government may survive merely because the opposition may not like to defeat the government either to gain political advantage or not to be deprived of their existing political base.

1989 ELECTIONS
CONGRESS LARGEST PARTY
BJP SUPPORT TO JANATA DAL



RATHYATRA | NO CONFIDENCE VOTE | 356 VS 151

- Electoral coalitions represent two or more than two political parties who enter into an agreement which provides for a mutual withdrawal of candidates in an election so that the concerned parties can avoid splitting of votes in the constituencies where they are strong respectively.

- Such coalitions are difficult to be formed when the parties having strong local base and organisation do not wish to surrender their rights to put up a candidate.

- Such electoral coalitions have become common in India in recent past in the form of formation of United Front and National Democratic Alliance.

CONGRESS – 421
NCP – 19
DMK – 20
RJD - 20

- In two party political systems, such as the United Kingdom, USA, coalition governments are rare.

- In the countries with multiparty systems, such as India, almost all the governments have been coalitions.

INDIAN POLITICS SINCE THE BEGINNING

- Indian politics in the period between 1947 to 1967 was coalitional in nature.
- However, political scientists like Rajni Kothari have called this one-party dominant system.
- The dominance of Congress was reflected both in terms of the number of seats that it held in parliament at centre and the governments it formed in the states as well as in terms of its formidable organizational strength outside the legislative bodies.
- Thus in the first three general elections Congress won around 45 percent of the votes and 75 percent of the seats in the parliament.
- The congress barring brief interludes continued to rule in almost all the states and at centre.
- The Congress system reflected 'dominance co-existing with competition but without a trace of alteration'.
- Such a dominance of congress reduced other parties to marginality.

- Despite the widespread presence of coalition governments in both developed and developing countries, there are not sufficient constitutional provisions regarding the process of formulation and dissolution of coalition governments.

1996

Vajpayee Govt

13 days

BSP

Withdrew

Support

- German constitution is a significant exception which has provisions which make it impossible for irresponsible parliamentarians to overthrow a government without being ready to support an alternative.

- The 1967 elections witnessed the coalition politics in another form, now involving the non-congress opposition parties.

- Opposition parties were able to defeat congress in the assembly elections in six States by joining into an electoral coalition.

- The Congress that Indira Gandhi led to power in 1971 was in many ways a new party that had to negotiate a new terrain of electoral politics marked by the presence of a great many new entrants from the 'middle' peasant castes and the regional groups into the game of electoral politics turning it into truly competitive.

SAREES
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INDIAN EXPRESS
Largest combined net sales among all daily newspapers in India
Vol. XLV No. 124 New Delhi: Friday March 25, 1977 25 p

SAREES FOR DAILY & WEAR
RAMCHANDRA KRISHNACHANDRA

MORARJI DESAI IS PRIME MINISTER

Consensus move dropped after letter from Charan Singh

By KULDIP NAYAR

NEW DELHI, March 24.
Mr Morarji Desai is India's new Prime Minister.

He is backed by the ruling alliance of 298 members — Janata Party (271), the Akalis (8), Peasants and Workers Party (3), Republican Party (2) and a dozen other members — and by Congress For Democracy (28) and the Marxists (22).

CFD to stay separate, back Govt on merit

Express Correspondent

Immediate concern to right all wrongs of emergency

Express Correspondent

Mr Morarji Desai being sworn in Prime Minister by Mr B. D. Jatti, acting President. — Express photo/Sub.

Lok Sabha to sit till April 6

Express Correspondent

Curfew in Lucknow after clashes

Express Correspondent

JANTA GOVERNMENT OF 1977

- First experience of coalition government
- Under the leadership of Morarji desai
- It was supported by Janata Morcha, Charan Singh's Bharatiya Lok Dal, Swatantra Party, the Socialist Party of India of George Fernandes, and the Bharatiya Jana Sangh (BJS)
- They remained in government, in power for two years: 1977-1979
- the power struggle in the government did not allow Desai to continue anymore.
- Once the no confidence motion against Desai was discussed in the lower house mr. Desai tendered his resignation.
- The Janta government collapsed in July 1979 when defections started with George Fernandes ,H.N.Bahuguna ,Biju Patnaik and others leaving

CHARAN SINGH GOVERNMENT

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INDIAN EXPRESS

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Published from New Delhi, Chandigarh, Bombay, Madras, Madurai, Vijayawada, Hyderabad, Bangalore, Ahmedabad and Cochin

Vol. XLVII No. 228 New Delhi: Friday July 27, 1979 33 p

RAM CHANDRA KRISHAN CHANDRA

Charan Singh is new Prime Minister

Cabinet to be formed today

Confidence vote by mid-August

By Kuldip Nayar

NEW DELHI, July 26.

Mr Charan Singh will be India's new Prime Minister.

He has carried the day with 102 members, and the President has invited him to form the Government which Mr Charan Singh says he will do in a day or so. He will have a small team to begin with.

The President has, however, asked him to seek a vote of confidence from the Lok Sabha "at the earliest possible opportunity, not by the third week of August 1979."

Even though Mr Charan Singh does not have 270 members to enjoy an absolute majority in the 529-member house, by the time he is ready for a vote of confidence, he may have gathered enough support. The nine Akalis may now join him as may some of those who have been unhappy with Mr Desai but did not want to leave the party at the time of crisis.

The game of numbers was tossed and the Janata claim of 270 was an exaggerated one. It appears that neither Mr Desai (the pre Mr Charan Pawar) nor the party, the two on whom it relied almost pathetically till the last minute.

All Mr Desai's managers now blame one another for having put it a wrong claim — 270 behind of 228 — but he has borne the brunt, the Secretary of the Congress Parliamentary said. "It is a sad and tragic reflection on the conduct of one who has always given the impression of being the source of all moral authority and courage."

Mr Desai has had inflict in his own party as well. Many members blame him for pulling down the Janata and not allowing Mr Jagjivan Ram or Mr Chandra Shekhar to take over. The feeling is that either of the two, particularly the former, would have retrieved the situation for the party.

This will remain one of the ironies of political history but many have no doubt that the tumbling down of Mr Desai came too back might have helped his party.

Another thing that may have helped is a unanimous mandate by the Janata that no member of the party could be a member of the RSS. As late as Wednesday morning, Mr Biju Patnaik pleaded, Mr K. E. Raju, the Janata party Secretary General, to request that if such a conditional statement were to be made by Mr Desai or Mr Chandra Shekhar, "we would all troop back."

Perhaps, events in the Janata were taking place in such rapid sequence that the party would have lost power in any case, in other words government.

Mr Desai can take the credit for holding together a coalition like government for almost two and a half years — but only for holding it together. Otherwise, he was the a chairman presiding over a routine board meeting. He was too complacent to bother about fundamental economic changes.

The pressure within the Janata

continued on p 5 col 1

The tally

NEW DELHI, July 26 (UNI).

Mr Charan Singh, Prime Minister-designate, assured the support of about 102 member sales (not about 228 of the outgoing Prime Minister, Mr Morarji Desai, according to some sources.

Charan gets time to prove majority

Express News Service

NEW DELHI, July 26.

Charan Singh, Prime Minister-designate, asked the President, Mr Sanjiva Reddy, at Rashtrapati Bhavan on Thursday, inviting him to form a government to replace the caretaker government at the Centre. — Express photograph by R. K. Sharma.

Life's ambition is fulfilled

Express News Service

Chavan offered

Charan blames Desai

Express News Service

NEW DELHI, July 26.

Chaudhary Charan Singh was the only prime minister of India who did not face Parliament.

When Morarji Desai govt fell, Charan Singh became the PM with the outside support of Congress and the communist party.

Just before he was to prove his majority in Lok Sabha, Indira Gandhi withdrew support to Charan Singh's government, and after just 23 days in power, he resigned.

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CHARAN SINGH RESIGNS

'Mrs Gandhi terms were untenable'

Express News Service

NEW DELHI, Aug 20.

Mr Charan Singh said in a statement today that he had resigned because he did not want support from Mrs Indira Gandhi who wanted him to withdraw certain cases against her relating to emergency excesses.

This is for the first time that Mr Charan Singh has said that Mrs Gandhi had attached conditions to her support to his Government. The position had all along maintained that the Congress (I) had extended unconditional support to it.

Mr Singh did not name Mrs Gandhi in the statement but his reference to the "unfortunate event" and the "quarters which sought interference in the normal functioning of the judiciary" left no doubt to whom he was referring.

"The country would not have forgiven us if we had, for the sake of remaining in the office, agreed to withdraw prosecutions against persons responsible for atrocities during emergency and for subverting machinery of government and institutions and handiwork of the elite...

Fresh poll advice to President

Jagjivan Ram stakes claim

By H. K. Dua
Our Political Correspondent

NEW DELHI, Aug 20.

Mr Charan Singh's coalition Government, which was in office for 23 days, submitted its resignation this morning and advised the President to order fresh Parliamentary elections.

Soon after Mr Charan Singh handed in his resignation to the President, the Leader of the Opposition, Mr Jagjivan Ram, met Mr Sanjiva Reddy, and stated his claim to form government. Mr Jagjivan Ram opposed Mr Charan Singh's advice for dissolution of the Lok Sabha.

Late tonight the possibility of the President ultimately declining to dissolve the Lok Sabha and order fresh elections in winter could not be ruled out.

If Mr Reddy chooses this course of action this will be mainly on the ground that several parties including the ruling partners, the Congress (I) and the two communist parties — had suggested fresh elections.

The ball is now in the President's court. He has two options: to invite Mr Jagjivan Ram to form a new government or to accept Mr Charan Singh's advice and dissolve the Lok Sabha.

To sort out his dilemma, Mr Sanjiva Reddy today held discussions with leaders of several political parties and some jurists but gave no inkling of on what lines he is thinking. The President is likely to give his decision tomorrow afternoon.

Mr Charan Singh met the President twice during the day to request that the advice given by his Council of Ministers for the dissolution of the Lok Sabha and that the advice of a Prime Minister who is yet to prove his majority is of little value for the President. The President, in Mr Jagjivan Ram's view, has got to satisfy himself before he is in a position to form a stable government.

Leaders of various political parties, including the Congress (I) and the two Communist parties, in their discussions with the President stressed that only fresh elections, possibly in November, will clarify the situation. The President is reported to have told them that he would consider their viewpoint.

The day's high political drama began in the morning with the Congress (I) Parliamentary Board deciding that the party would oppose Mr Charan Singh's motion seeking a vote of confidence in the Lok Sabha. Mr Charan Singh, who came to power with Mrs Gandhi's help, summoned an emergency meeting of the Cabinet at his house to chalk out the course of action.

Rather than facing a defeat on the floor of the House, Mr Charan Singh and his colleagues favoured to resign immediately. The Cabinet decided to recommend to the President dissolution of the Lok Sabha which has lived only half of its five-year term.

Singh came to Rashtrapati Bhavan and handed in his resignation later and advised a mid-term poll. The President accepted the resignation but asked Mr Charan Singh to continue till alternative arrangements were made.

While political scene was changing fast, the Lok Sabha members, who had filled the high-ceiling chamber, did not know what to do with the motion of confidence that the Prime Minister was to move. Mr Charan Singh, having gone to Rashtrapati Bhavan, was not present in the House.

It was the Speaker, who read out a letter from the Prime Minister and gave the first indication that Mr Charan Singh had chosen to resign rather than face a certain defeat in the House.

The Speaker also did not know what to do. There was no word from the President. The House was adjourned till 2 p.m. when it was adjourned sine die.

In the Central Hall excitement ran high with worried members of all parties discussing new situation: will the President call upon the parliamentary caucus tomorrow by ordering a mid-term poll or will he invite Mr Jagjivan Ram to form a government.

Advice binding, says PM

Express News Service

NEW DELHI, Aug 20.

Mr Charan Singh asserts that

Mrs Gandhi demands early poll

Express News Service

NEW DELHI, Aug 20

Mrs Indira Gandhi today met the President and reportedly asked for a mid-term poll as soon as possible.

Earlier, during the day the Congress-I Parliamentary Board discussed at two meetings whether the party should support Mr Charan Singh's recommendation to the President that the Lok Sabha should be dissolved and a mid-term poll ordered.

Before the parliamentary board met for the second time, Mrs Gandhi had met the party PCC chief and other state leaders who were in Delhi. According to Congress-I sources, they overwhelmingly voted for a mid-term poll.

Mr A. K. Antony, Congress-I general secretary, told reporters that the parliamentary board might meet again tonight. But the meeting did not come off.

"Is your party ready for a mid-term poll?" in answer to this question, Mr Antony said: "In view of the fact that the ultimate decision is a democratically set-up entity rather than the personal decision, if an opportunity were to be given to them to give their views on the design, evidence and non-design of the ...

V P SINGH GOVERNMENT OF 1989

- Third coalition was formed in the name of national front under the leadership of V.P.Singh in December 1989.
- V.P.Singh government was supported by BJP
- Congress was the single largest party but it could not form the government
- National front government had also the support of CPI, CPI(M), and the Forward Block.
- But, the period was short lived when BJP withdrew its support to V.P.Singh on the eve of Advani's arrest on the backdrop of his Rath Yatra.

THE TIMES OF INDIA

NEW DELHI SUNDAY DECEMBER 3, 1989

V. P. ASSUMES OFFICE

Devi Lal takes over as deputy premier

Cabinet formation in a day or two

BJP quiet on Devi issue

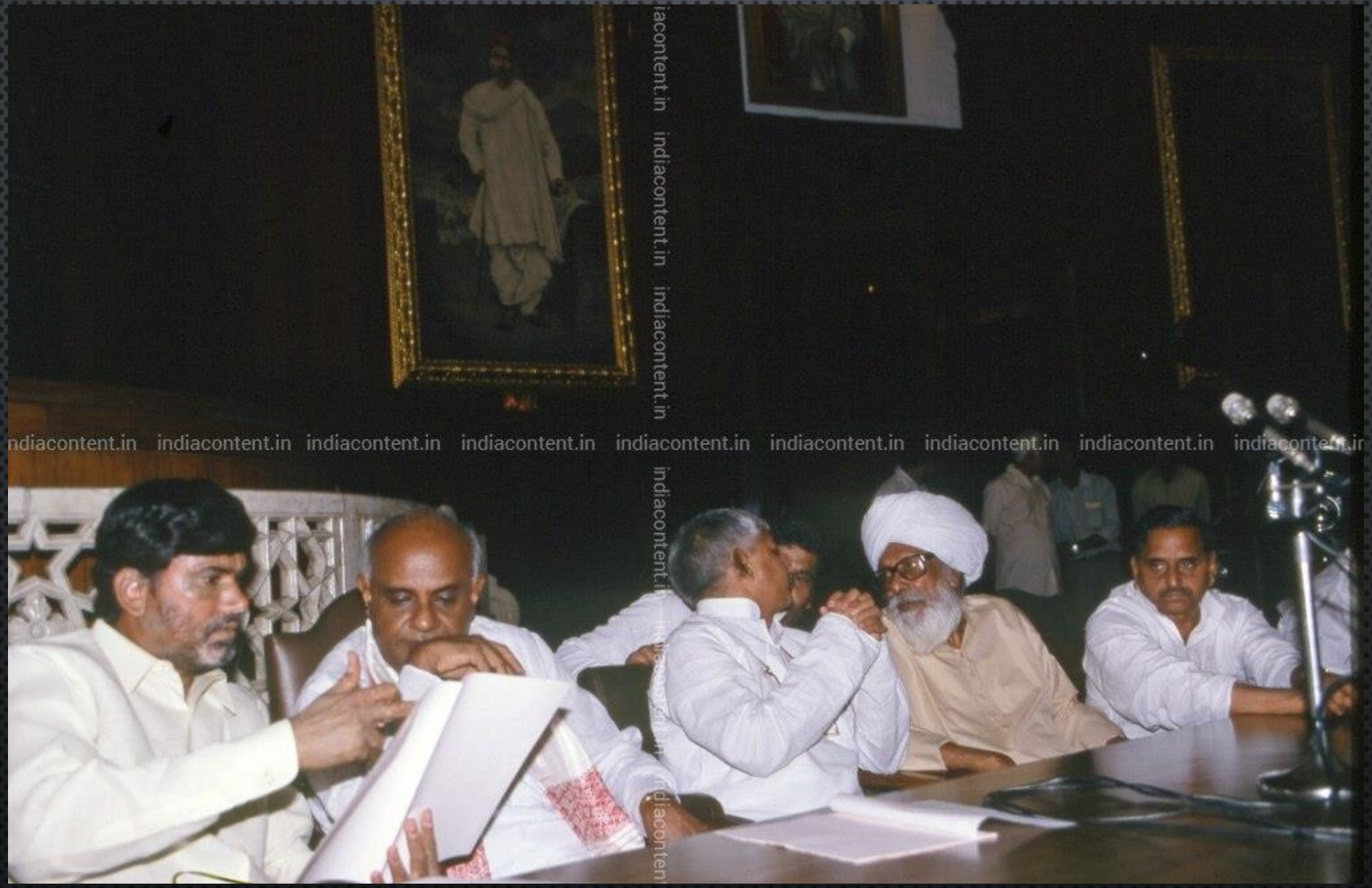
Chautala is Haryana CM

Efforts on for coalition: Devi

Chandrashekhar stays away

UNITED FRONT GOVERNMENT 1996 AND 1998

- The Indian general election in 1996 gave a fractured verdict With the Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP)emerging as the largest party, with 161 of 543 seats, it was invited first to form a government. It accepted the offer, and Atal Bihari Vajpayee was sworn in as prime minister.
- However, he was unable to muster a majority on the floor of the house, and the government fell 13 days later.
- A new coalition government was formed with the support of congress and the communist party of india and it was named as the United front government
- Other parties included Samajwadi Party, Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam (DMK), and Telugu Desam Party (TDP) and others
- H. D. DeveGowda, was asked to head the coalition as Prime Minister.


indiacontent.in

- The Congress took back its support for Gowda and the government fell.
- New support was given to a new government under I. K. Gujral, who was Prime Minister from April 21, 1997 – March 19, 1998.
- Congress took back its support for Gujral also in 1998 and fresh elections were called.